

Philipp Hilbert. *Digital banking product owner, SME channels.*

Positioning, SME-focused product leader with 13 years of regulated-industry delivery, from backlog to production, across mobile, web, and platform teams.

BERLIN, GERMANY · HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN · [TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](https://www.true-north.berlin)

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

§ WHY MASHREQ

Mashreq is doing something structurally interesting: running a single SME digital product across three markets, UAE, Egypt, Pakistan, on a shared platform with genuine reusability ambitions, not just a copy-paste codebase. The posting names that tension explicitly: global-by-default, minimal duplication, yet locally relevant. That is harder than it sounds, and it is exactly the kind of cross-market backlog problem I have dealt with. The reference to Mashreq Biz as an end-to-end Build & Run ownership mandate, not a project handoff, also stands out, it matches how I think about product accountability. *That kind of full-lifecycle ownership, from discovery through live-service operations, is where my instincts are sharpest.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

Mashreq's SME banking stack lives on regulated financial-services infrastructure, core banking, AML, KYC workflows, and multi-country regulatory compliance, which I have not shipped directly. My closest domain is payments (Kvitt, a P2P product operating inside the girocard ecosystem) and regulated B2B platforms (insurance, healthcare, public-sector). The operational mechanics, backlog ownership, cross-market alignment, agile delivery, live-service incident response, transfer cleanly; the banking-specific compliance layer I would close quickly from the inside.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, paired development and edge-case coverage
- **Cursor / VSCode**, LLM-assisted coding environment
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy interface work
- **GPT**, drafting, evaluation loops, and prompt testing
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder presentations

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kafka, Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Dagster, dbt, SQL, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

A two-sided B2B marketplace matching construction firms with workers, removing the headhunter from the hire.

- Anonymity-until-payment model protecting both sides until commitment is made.
- WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface; LLM agents across the funnel for single-operator day-to-day running.
- Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL; zero to one, built alone.
- Demonstrates the full-stack PM instinct, discovery, architecture choice, go-to-market, and live-service ops, that Mashreq's Build & Run mandate requires.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT MASHREQ

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the Mashreq Biz squads in UAE, Egypt, and Pakistan, read the current roadmap and backlog, identify where cross-market dependency management is causing slip or duplication, and establish where the biggest customer friction sits in the MOB and MOL journeys.

WEEK 2

Slice and prioritise.

Run a structured backlog review session with the proxy Product Owners and engineering leads, surface the top ten items blocking CSAT and MAU, and draft a first-cut priority order with explicit rationale tied to customer outcomes.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

Own sprint planning, drive the first release through business readiness and go-live with Operations, and establish a lightweight weekly rhythm for cross-market backlog alignment so global-by-default is a practice, not a slide.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team,

Mashreq's ambition to lead digital SME banking across the UAE, Egypt, and Pakistan is a genuinely hard problem, and the job description makes it clear the company understands why: owning a shared platform across three regulatory environments, three market contexts, and two channels while still keeping customer journeys consistent and reusable is structurally different from running a single-country product. That challenge is what drew me to this role.

My background is in product ownership across regulated industries with real accountability, meaning I have held the roadmap, the backlog, the release, and the live-service performance, not handed them off after delivery. At Rohde & Schwarz I owned the AI and data platform for the FCAS European defence programme, managing a cross-functional team of fifteen engineers and data scientists, introducing GitOps delivery that cut rollout time from days to thirty minutes, and redirecting the entire product strategy based on instrumented workflow data. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I ran a national labour-market analytics platform as Product Manager and Deputy IT Security Officer simultaneously, migrating a bare-metal system to containers, launching a full UI relaunch, and introducing Dagster and dbt to eliminate manual ETL effort. Both roles required coordinating across engineering, data science, compliance, and executive stakeholders in environments where a mistake in production had visible consequences.

The SME-specific demand in this role, self-service adoption, digital engagement, customer effort reduction, maps closely to work I have done in adjacent contexts. At CLINET Platforms I took a mobile patient app team that could not deliver its roadmap and cut the backlog to the top ten percent of features; user acceptance rose more than fivefold. At EMIL Group I restructured an eighteen-person delivery organisation to stop engineer attrition and rebuild client trust, then shipped the Claims Center from concept to production. At Kvitt Payment Solutions I built a P2P mobile payments product from zero and took it to acquisition inside the girocard ecosystem. The common thread is end-to-end ownership: I stay accountable from the discovery interview through the incident postmortem.

I am an EU citizen currently based in Berlin, and I am actively targeting the UAE. I am prepared to relocate to Dubai for this role and to work fully on-site. The multi-market scope across UAE, Egypt, and Pakistan is a feature, not a complication, for me. My experience coordinating multinational engineering and stakeholder groups across time zones and regulatory contexts means I have already built the operating rhythm this kind of cross-border product governance requires.

I would be glad to walk through any part of my experience in more detail or to discuss how I would approach the first ninety days in the role.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Owner and Product Manager with 13 years of regulated-industry product ownership across payments, insurance, healthcare, defence AI, and public-sector analytics. Experienced in end-to-end digital product delivery, roadmap through live-service operations, across agile squads in complex, multi-stakeholder environments. Grounded in Scrum, Kanban, and SAFe; comfortable as the person accountable for customer outcomes, platform reliability, and team velocity simultaneously.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, sprint review, retrospective, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and Roadmap Ownership, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning.

Stakeholder and Leadership: stakeholder management, cross-functional team leadership, C-level and executive reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

SDLC and Delivery Practices: GitOps with ArgoCD, CI/CD, containerised environments, regression and end-to-end test automation, release gating, defect-to-fix cycle time as a product metric.

Technical Environments: Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, Jenkins, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, EU AI Act, Explainable AI; prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Governance: GDPR/DSGVO, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI & DATA PLATFORM 2024-2025

GitOps rollout with ArgoCD cut deployment time from days to 30 minutes; redirected product strategy based on instrumented workflow data, lifting pipeline runs 200%; managed 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum across a multinational FCAS programme.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

Introduced Dagster and dbt, reducing data update effort by 75%; migrated a bare-metal system to containers; carried a full UI relaunch and large ETL migration concurrently; served as Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE 2023-2023

Cut an undeliverable roadmap to its top 10% of features; user acceptance rose fivefold; shipped CGM/KIS integration reducing digital anamnesis time from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022-2022

Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; attrition dropped from near-total exodus to one departure; shipped Claims Center from concept to production; cut new-product launch time from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · RETAIL & PAYMENTS POS 2021-2022

Moved research results to production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · SECURE GOVERNMENT DATA 2021-2021

Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE B2B PROCUREMENT 2019-2020

Migrated a legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production; backlog refinement, user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY IT 2019-2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE CLINICAL NETWORK 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION B2B MARKETPLACE 2025-PRESENT

Zero-to-one two-sided marketplace; anonymity-until-payment model; LLM agents across the funnel; funnel analysis in SQL.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped a three-layer quantum-secure encryption product with sub-two-minute installation for enterprise buyers; later Chair of the Board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO · AGRITECH
2018-2021

Took a nanotechnology fertiliser product from lab to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P
PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Built a mobile group-based P2P payments product from zero; acquired by Sparkasse, operating inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · MASHREQ

→